OAVS TGT · Current Affairs

Awards, Books & Honours

Built from the award questions in your 5 previous-year papers

Coverage window: Jan 2025 – 28 Oct 2026

How this part is organised

Awards were **13 of 150** current-affairs questions in your papers (about 9%, or 2–3 per paper). Literary prizes were the most frequent, then film and arts honours, then global and civilian honours. The sections follow that order of likelihood.

Section	Topic	Why it matters
1	Civil honours: Bharat Ratna and Padma Awards	Bharat Ratna and global honours asked in 2022 and 2024
2	Literature: Jnanpith, Sahitya Akademi, Booker, Nobel Literature	Most frequent type: 5 of 13 PYQs
3	Nobel Prizes 2025 and 2026	Nobel Peace asked in 2024
4	Film and arts: Oscars, National Film Awards, Phalke	Tansen Samman, IFFK, Phalke-type questions
5	Sports and other international honours (Ballon d'Or)	Cross-links with Part 1
6	Posthumous honourees and notable deaths	Obituary question in 2024 (K. Viswanath)
7	Practice MCQs (25) and answer key	—

Reliability key. ✔ = checked against live web sources on 28 Oct 2026. ◆ = from my own knowledge, so cross-check once before the exam. Unmarked static facts come from your PYQ keys.

What the PYQs tell us

Paper	Q	Topic asked	Type
Sci 2024	45	Sahitya Akademi Award for Assamese short stories 'Bhool Satya' – Manoj Kumar Goswami	Literature
Sci 2024	67	UNEP Champions of the Earth 2022 – Purnima Devi Barman	Global honour
Maths 2024	41	Kasinadhuni Viswanath (d. Feb 2023) – film director	Obituary
Maths 2024	43	International Booker Prize 2022 – Tomb of Sand	Literature
Maths 2024	60	Nobel Peace Prize 2022 – Ales Bialiatski	Nobel
Maths 2024	67	Bharat Ratna 2024 – L. K. Advani	Civil honour
Eng 2019	12	Pulitzer Prize 2019 fiction – The Overstory	Literature
Eng 2019	13	Tansen Samman (music award; question text unreadable in your scan)	Arts
Eng 2019	15	IFFK 23rd edition, Suvarna Chakoram – Dark Room	Film festival
Eng 2019	19	Sahitya Akademi Award 2018, Hindi – Chitra Mudgal	Literature
Eng 2022	14	Balkrishna Doshi – Royal Gold Medal 2022	Global honour
Eng 2022	22	Ayurveda Ratan Award 2020 – Dr Partap Chauhan	Health / global
SS 2023	21	Miss Universe 2022 – R'Bonney Gabriel (71st edition)	Pageant

Patterns to exploit

- **Literature is 5 of 13** (Sahitya Akademi ×2, Booker, Pulitzer, plus Nobel Peace as a prize question). Learn winner, book, language and prize money.
- **Questions give the achievement and ask for the person, or give the person and ask for the field.** 'Which author won ... for Bhool Satya?', 'Viswanath was a known ...'.
- **Nobel and Bharat Ratna appear regularly** and are easy marks if you know the latest year's winners.
- **Recency:** the awards asked were usually from the previous 12–18 months, so 2026 winners below are the top tier.
- **One answer-key quirk:** the 2019 English paper's Q13 shows only options (Tansen Samman marked correct) because the question text was cut off in the scan.

1. Civil honours

1A. Bharat Ratna

Fact	Detail	Chk
Latest recipients	**No Bharat Ratna was announced for 2025 or the first half of 2026.** The latest cohort is 2024: **Karpoori Thakur** (posthumous), **L. K. Advani**, **P. V. Narasimha Rao** (posthumous), **Chaudhary Charan Singh** (posthumous) and **M. S. Swaminathan** (posthumous). Five in one year was a record. Total recipients: **53** (14 posthumous, 2 non-citizens)	✔
Rules	Recommended by the Prime Minister to the President; **maximum 3 per year** (2024 was an exception); cannot be used as a prefix or suffix to a name (Article 18(1)); medallion shaped like a peepal leaf	✔
Firsts	First recipients 1954: **C. Rajagopalachari, S. Radhakrishnan, C. V. Raman** · first woman Indira Gandhi (1971) · first posthumous Lal Bahadur Shastri (1966) · youngest Sachin Tendulkar (2014, age 40) · non-citizens: Khan Abdul Ghaffar Khan (1987), Nelson Mandela (1990)	✔

1B. Padma Awards 2026

Fact	Detail	Chk
Overview	Announced on 25 Jan 2026, eve of the 77th Republic Day: **131 awards** = 5 Padma Vibhushan + 13 Padma Bhushan + 113 Padma Shri; 19 women, 16 posthumous, 6 foreigners/NRIs/PIOs/OCIs. Investiture: first ceremony 26 May 2026 (66 awards), second ceremony the rest	✔
Padma Vibhushan (5)	**Dharmendra** (posthumous) · **K. T. Thomas** · **N. Rajam** · **P. Narayanan** · **V. S. Achuthanandan** (posthumous)	✔
Padma Bhushan (13)	Alka Yagnik · Bhagat Singh Koshyari · Kalpatti Ramasamy Palanisamy · **Mammootty** · Nori Dattatreyudu · **Piyush Pandey** (posth.) · K. M. Maelanandhan · Shatavadhani R. Ganesh · **Shibu Soren** (posth.) · **Uday Kotak** · V. K. Malhotra (posth.) · Vellappally Natesan · **Vijay Amritraj**	✔
Also on the list	Cricketer **Rohit Sharma** is among the 2026 Padma awardees (in the Padma Shri list)	✔
Padma Awards 2025 (previous year)	Announced Jan 2025. Padma Vibhushan to Dr D. Nageshwar Reddy, J. S. Khehar, Kumudini Lakhia, Laxminarayana Subramaniam, M. T. Vasudevan Nair (posth.), Osamu Suzuki (posth.) and Sharda Sinha (posth.)	◆
Static facts	Instituted 1954; announced on Republic Day eve by the Ministry of Home Affairs; ranking: Bharat Ratna, then Padma Vibhushan, Padma Bhushan, Padma Shri; Padma Committee is constituted by the PM each year	✔

2. Literature and book prizes

Prize	Latest winner	Key facts	Chk
Jnanpith Award 2025 (60th)	**R. Vairamuthu** (Tamil poet and lyricist)	Announced 14 Mar 2026. Third Tamil writer to win (after Akilan 1975, Jayakanthan 2002) and the first for Tamil poetry. Selection committee chaired by Pratibha Ray. Prize ₹11 lakh, bronze statuette of Vagdevi and citation. Instituted 1961; first winner G. Sankara Kurup (1965); first woman Ashapurna Devi (1976)	✔
Jnanpith 2024 (59th)	Vinod Kumar Shukla (Hindi)	Announced Mar 2025	◆
Sahitya Akademi Awards 2025	24 writers, 24 languages (22 scheduled + English + Rajasthani)	Announced **16 Mar 2026** after a three-month delay (a December 2025 press conference was cancelled). Presented 31 Mar 2026; ₹1 lakh, copper plaque and shawl. **English: Navtej Sarna** (novel *Crimson Spring*, set around Jallianwala Bagh). **Hindi: Mamta Kalia** (memoir *Jeete Jee Allahabad*). **Tamil: Sa. Tamilselvan** (criticism *Thamizh Sirukathaiyin Thadangal*). Urdu: Pritpal Singh Betab (*Safar Jaari Hai*). Assamese: Devabrat Das (*Karhi Khelar Sadhu*). Bengali: Prasun Bandyopadhyay. 8 poetry, 4 novels, 6 short-story, 2 essay, 1 criticism, 1 autobiography, 2 memoir books	✔
Booker Prize 2025	**David Szalay**, *Flesh*	Announced 10 Nov 2025; £50,000; first Hungarian-British winner; judging chair Roddy Doyle. Shortlist included India-linked **Kiran Desai** (*The Loneliness of Sonia and Sunny*). 2024 winner: Samantha Harvey (*Orbital*)	✔
International Booker 2026	**Taiwan Travelogue** by Yáng Shuāng-zǐ, translated by **Lin King**	Announced 19 May 2026 at Tate Modern, London; £50,000 split equally between author and translator; **first Mandarin-language winner** and first Taiwanese winners; And Other Stories won back-to-back; chair of judges Natasha Brown	✔
International Booker 2025	*Heart Lamp* by **Banu Mushtaq**, translated by **Deepa Bhasthi**	Kannada short stories; first Kannada-language winner. PYQ link: 2022 winner *Tomb of Sand* (Geetanjali Shree, Hindi, trans. Daisy Rockwell)	◆
Nobel Literature	2026 **Anne Carson** (Canada) · 2025 **László Krasznahorkai** (Hungary)	See Section 3	✔

Likely traps: Anuradha Roy (a 2024 PYQ distractor) did not win the 2025 Sahitya Akademi Award; the English winner is Navtej Sarna. The Sahitya Akademi Award is the second-highest literary honour after the Jnanpith.

3. Nobel Prizes

Category	2026 (announced 5–12 Oct 2026)	2025	Chk
Peace	**Navanethem 'Navi' Pillay** (South Africa) – 'for her efforts to promote peace and international law'	**María Corina Machado** (Venezuela)	✔/◆
Literature	**Anne Carson** (Canada) – poet, classicist, translator	**László Krasznahorkai** (Hungary)	✔
Physics	**Francis Halzen** – IceCube Neutrino Observatory and discovery of high-energy astrophysical neutrinos	John Clarke, Michel Devoret, John Martinis (macroscopic quantum tunnelling)	✔/◆
Chemistry	**Henri B. Kagan** (France) and **Kenso Soai** (Japan) – non-linear effects and autocatalysis in asymmetric synthesis	Susumu Kitagawa, Richard Robson, Omar Yaghi (metal-organic frameworks)	✔/◆
Medicine	**Karl Deisseroth, Peter Hegemann, Georg Nagel** – light-gated ion channels and **optogenetics**	Mary Brunkow, Fred Ramsdell, Shimon Sakaguchi (peripheral immune tolerance)	✔/◆
Economics	**Robert E. Hall** (USA) – 'microeconomic foundations of macroeconomic stabilisation'; one source also lists Michael Woodford as co-winner, so check	Joel Mokyr, Philippe Aghion, Peter Howitt (innovation-driven growth)	✔/◆

PYQ link: Nobel Peace 2022 was Ales Bialiatski (with Memorial and the Center for Civil Liberties). Nobel Prizes are presented on 10 December (Nobel's death anniversary), with the Peace Prize in Oslo and the others in Stockholm.

4. Film and arts

4A. Oscars (98th Academy Awards)

Fact	Detail	Chk
Ceremony	15 Mar 2026, Dolby Theatre, Los Angeles; host Conan O'Brien. **Best Casting** awarded for the first time (24 categories)	✔
Main winners	Best Picture **One Battle After Another** (biggest winner) · Director **Paul Thomas Anderson** · Actor **Michael B. Jordan** (*Sinners*, first Oscar) · Actress **Jessie Buckley** (*Hamnet*) · Supporting Actor **Sean Penn** · Supporting Actress **Amy Madigan** (*Weapons*)	✔
Other categories	International Feature **Sentimental Value** (Norway) · Animated Feature **KPop Demon Hunters** (song 'Golden' won Best Original Song) · Documentary **Mr. Nobody Against Putin** · Original Screenplay Ryan Coogler (*Sinners*)	✔

4B. National Film Awards and Dadasaheb Phalke Award

Edition	Key winners	Chk
72nd NFA (films of 2024)	Announced **18 Jul 2026**; presented by President Droupadi Murmu on **22 Sep 2026 at Ekta Nagar, Kevadia, Gujarat** (first venue outside Delhi). Best Feature Film **Article 370** (dir. Aditya Suhas Jambhale) · Best Actor **Mammootty** (*Bramayugam*) and **Kartik Aaryan** (*Chandu Champion*), shared · Best Actress **Yami Gautam** (*Article 370*) · Supporting Actor Sanjay Mishra (*Bhakshak*) · Popular film *Kalki 2898 AD* · Debut director Randeep Hooda (*Swatantrya Veer Savarkar*) · Non-feature *Bhangaar* · Documentary *Ram-Nami*	✔
Dadasaheb Phalke Award 2024	**Anant Nag** (Kannada actor, over five decades); announced 16 Sep 2026, presented at the 72nd NFA ceremony	✔
71st NFA (films of 2023)	Presented 23 Sep 2025, Vigyan Bhawan, Delhi. Best Feature *12th Fail* · Best Actor **Shah Rukh Khan** (*Jawan*) and **Vikrant Massey** (*12th Fail*) · Best Actress **Rani Mukerji** (*Mrs Chatterjee vs Norway*) · Phalke Award **Mohanlal**	✔
Static facts	NFA instituted 1954, run by the Directorate of Film Festivals; the Phalke Award began in 1969, first recipient **Devika Rani**; best actor and actress awards started 1968	✔

PYQ link: the 2019 paper asked about the IFFK Golden Crow Pheasant (Suvarna Chakoram) and the Tansen Samman, so festival and music-honour questions are fair game. I did not research IFFK 2025 or IFFI 2025, so check those once.

5. Sports and other international honours

Award	Facts	Chk
Ballon d'Or 2025	Men: **Ousmane Dembélé** (PSG, France) · Women: **Aitana Bonmatí** (Barcelona, Spain). Previous men's winner Rodri (2024); Messi holds the record with 8	✔
Ballon d'Or 2026	**70th edition**, ceremony on **26 Oct 2026 at the London Palladium** – the first time outside Paris (honouring Stanley Matthews, the first winner in 1956). Covers 3 Aug 2025 – 19 Jul 2026, including the World Cup. **I could not find the result yet, so check it**	✔
National Sports Awards	Khel Ratna 2024 (presented Jan 2025): Manu Bhaker, D. Gukesh, Harmanpreet Singh, Praveen Kumar – see Part 1 (Sports)	✔

6. Posthumous honourees and notable deaths

Person	Field	Note	Chk
Dharmendra	Actor	Padma Vibhushan 2026 (posthumous); died Nov 2025	✔
V. S. Achuthanandan	Politician, former Kerala CM	Padma Vibhushan 2026 (posthumous); died July 2025	◆
Shibu Soren	Jharkhand leader	Padma Bhushan 2026 (posthumous); died Aug 2025	◆
Piyush Pandey	Advertising professional	Padma Bhushan 2026 (posthumous); died Oct 2025	◆
V. K. Malhotra	Politician	Padma Bhushan 2026 (posthumous)	✔

PYQ link: the 2024 Maths paper asked who Kasinadhuni Viswanath was (film director, died Feb 2023). Expect 'X was a known ...' questions about people who died in the previous year. I will cover other 2025–26 obituaries in a later part.

7. Practice MCQs (25)

Answers are on the last page. Each question uses facts marked ✔ above.

1. Who won the Nobel Peace Prize 2026?
(A) Maria Ressa (B) Navi Pillay (C) Ales Bialiatski (D) Narges Mohammadi

2. The Nobel Prize in Literature 2026 was awarded to:
(A) Anne Carson (B) Han Kang (C) Jon Fosse (D) Louise Glück

3. The Nobel Prize in Physics 2026 recognised work on which observatory?
(A) LIGO (B) CERN (C) IceCube (D) Hubble

4. The 2026 Nobel Prize in Medicine honoured discoveries in:
(A) mRNA vaccines (B) CRISPR (C) Gut microbiome (D) Optogenetics

5. Nobel Peace Prize 2025 winner:
(A) María Corina Machado (B) Navi Pillay (C) Narges Mohammadi (D) Abiy Ahmed

6. Nobel Literature 2025 winner László Krasznahorkai is from:
(A) Poland (B) Hungary (C) Czechia (D) Romania

7. How many Padma Awards were announced for 2026?
(A) 119 (B) 125 (C) 131 (D) 139

8. The posthumous Padma Vibhushan 2026 actor:
(A) Piyush Pandey (B) Mammootty (C) Alka Yagnik (D) Dharmendra

9. Which actor received the Padma Bhushan 2026 from Malayalam cinema?
(A) Mammootty (B) Mohanlal (C) Dulquer Salmaan (D) Fahadh Faasil

10. How many Bharat Ratna awards were announced for 2025?
(A) One (B) None (C) Two (D) Three

11. Maximum Bharat Ratna awards allowed per year:
(A) 1 (B) 2 (C) 3 (D) 5

12. Booker Prize 2025 was won by:
(A) Kiran Desai (B) Andrew Miller (C) Katie Kitamura (D) David Szalay

13. International Booker Prize 2026 winning book:
(A) Taiwan Travelogue (B) Heart Lamp (C) Tomb of Sand (D) Orbital

14. The 2026 International Booker was the first win for a book originally written in:
(A) Japanese (B) Mandarin Chinese (C) Korean (D) Arabic

15. The 60th Jnanpith Award (for 2025) went to:
(A) Gulzar (B) Rahman Rahi (C) Vairamuthu (D) Perumal Murugan

16. Cash prize of the Jnanpith Award:
(A) ₹5 lakh (B) ₹7 lakh (C) ₹21 lakh (D) ₹11 lakh

17. Sahitya Akademi Award 2025 for English went to:
(A) Navtej Sarna (B) Anuradha Roy (C) Amitav Ghosh (D) Jhumpa Lahiri

18. Cash prize of the Sahitya Akademi Award:
(A) ₹50,000 (B) ₹1 lakh (C) ₹2 lakh (D) ₹5 lakh

19. Best Picture at the 98th Oscars:
(A) Sinners (B) Hamnet (C) One Battle After Another (D) Frankenstein

20. Best Actor at the 98th Oscars:
(A) Timothée Chalamet (B) Wagner Moura (C) Leonardo DiCaprio (D) Michael B. Jordan

21. The new Oscar category introduced in 2026:
(A) Best Casting (B) Best Stunt Design (C) Best Trailer (D) Best Voice

22. Best Feature Film at the 72nd National Film Awards:
(A) Kalki 2898 AD (B) Article 370 (C) Chandu Champion (D) Bramayugam

23. Dadasaheb Phalke Award for 2024 was given to:
(A) Mohanlal (B) Rajinikanth (C) Anant Nag (D) Mammootty

24. Where were the 72nd National Film Awards presented?
(A) Vigyan Bhawan, Delhi (B) Rashtrapati Bhavan (C) Mumbai (D) Ekta Nagar, Kevadia

25. Men's Ballon d'Or 2025 winner:
(A) Ousmane Dembélé (B) Lamine Yamal (C) Rodri (D) Kylian Mbappé

Answer key

1-B **2**-A **3**-C **4**-D **5**-A **6**-B **7**-C **8**-D **9**-A **10**-B **11**-C **12**-D **13**-A **14**-B **15**-C **16**-D **17**-A **18**-B **19**-C **20**-D **21**-A **22**-B **23**-C **24**-D **25**-A

Before you rely on this: items marked ◆ need one cross-check. Also check the Ballon d'Or 2026 result (ceremony 26 Oct 2026) and the Economics Nobel 2026 co-winner. Reply **'next'** for the next part (International affairs, summits, treaties and defence exercises is the largest remaining share of the PYQs).